Jessica H. Brown

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U.S. Citizen

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

University of South Carolina
Associate Professor of Economics — *August 2026-Present*
Assistant Professor of Economics (maternity leave 2020, 2023) — *August 2019-August 2026*
Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research
Policy Fellow — *January 2026-Present*
Institute for Labor Studies (IZA)
Research Fellow — *April 2024-Present*
Wilson-Sheehan Lab for Economic Opportunities
Faculty Affiliate — *October 2021-Present*

VISITING POSITIONS

Department of Economics, University of Virginia — *August 2026-May 2027*
Visiting Scholar
Griswold Center for Economic Policy Studies, Princeton University — *March 2025*
Short-Term Visiting Scholar
W.E. Upjohn Institute — *Summer 2022*
AEA Summer Fellow

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics — *2019*
Princeton University
Committee: Alan Krueger (chair), Leah Boustan, Will Dobbie, Alex Mas, Ilyana Kuziemko

M.A. in Economics — *2015*
Princeton University

B.S. in Mathematics and Economics, *magna cum laude* — *2011*
University of Notre Dame

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Child Care

PUBLISHED OR ACCEPTED PAPERS

"The Labor Market Effects of Pregnancy Accommodation Laws" with Emily Battaglia
Journal of Population Economics, Vol. 38, Article 88, 2025.

"Secure Communities as Immigration Enforcement: How Secure is the Child Care Market?" with Umair Ali and Chris M. Herbst
Journal of Public Economics, Vol.233:105101, 2024.

"The Impact of a Long-Term Care Information Campaign on Insurance Purchase"
Journal of Health Economics, Vol. 92:102822, 2023.

"Child Care over the Business Cycle" with Chris M. Herbst
Journal of Labor Economics, Vol. 40(S1): S429-S468, 2022.

"Mandated Benefits, Imperfect Information, and Moral Hazard: A Model and Application to Temporary Disability Insurance"
Southern Economic Journal, Vol. 88(3): 1037-1064, 2022.

"The Global COVID-19 Student Survey: First Wave Results" with David A. Jaeger, Jaime Arellano-Bover, Krzysztof Karbownik, Marta Martínez-Matute, John Nunley, R. Alan Seals, and 37 others
Covid Economics, Vol. 79(1): 152-217, 2021.

WORKING PAPERS

"Waiting by Design: A Model of Pricing and Waitlists in Child Care Markets" with Danna Kang Thomas

"Big Daycare: The Growth of Private Equity in the Child Care Market" with Chris M. Herbst
(under review)

"Minimum Wage, Worker Quality, and Consumer Well-Being: Evidence from the Child Care Market" with Chris M. Herbst
(Resubmitted following Third Round R&R, Journal of Human Resources)

"Undersupply or Lack of Demand?: Evaluating Measures of Child Care Access"
(R&R, Economics of Education Review)

"Does Public Pre-K Have Unintended Consequences on the Child Care Market for Infants and Toddlers?"

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Introductory Econometrics (Undergraduate), University of South Carolina	*Fall 2019-Fall 2025*
Public Finance II (Ph.D.), University of South Carolina	*Spring 2024, 2026*
Third-Year Seminar (Ph.D.), University of South Carolina	*Fall 2024*
Health Economics (Undergraduate), University of South Carolina	*Spring 2026*

PH.D. STUDENT SUPERVISION

Foteini Tzachrista (2022, dissertation committee member)
Angela Shoulders (2024, third-year paper reader)
Mohammad Jakaria (expected 2026, dissertation committee chair)
Kaleigh Strohl (expected 2027, dissertation committee chair)
Dylan Burke (expected 2027, dissertation committee chair)
Narender Mahor (expected 2028, dissertation committee chair)

AWARDS AND GRANTS

Moore Fellowship, Darla Moore School of Business, University of South Carolina	*2025-present*
Riegel and Emory Human Resource Center Grant ($5,000)	*2025-2026*
Riegel and Emory Human Resource Center Grant ($5,000)	*2024-2025*
Washington Center for Equitable Growth Early Career Scholar ($30,000)	*2024-2026*
Alfred P. Sloan Foundation Grant, with Chris M. Herbst ($454,022)	*2024-2027*
Darla Moore School of Business Internal Grant ($4,270)	*2023-2024*
Darla Moore School of Business Internal Grant ($2,000)	*2020-2021*
Darla Moore School of Business Internal Grant ($5,000)	*2019-2020*
Richard A. Lester Fellowship for Industrial Relations, Princeton University	*2017-2018*
Louis A. Simpson *60 Graduate Fellowship, Princeton University	*2013-2014*
Phi Beta Kappa, University of Notre Dame	*2011*
Omicron Delta Epsilon, University of Notre Dame	*2011*

SELECTED MEDIA

"2K's Bad Math: Could expanding free preschool bankrupt the program's child care providers?" *New York Magazine*, October 3, 2026

"Q&A with Economist Jessica Brown About Accurately Meausring Child Care Access and Demand" *New America*, July 18, 2026

"How New Mexico is trying to stabilize a broken child care market" *NPR Marketplace*, April 4, 2025

"The immigration crackdown threatening to break America's child care system" *Vox*, March 25, 2025

"The crushing cost of childcare" *CBS12 West Palm Beach*, August 12, 2024

"Families are paying an average of 30% more for child care than they did in 2019" *NPR's MarketPlace Morning Report*, October 31, 2023

"Newest way to woo workers: Child care at airports, schools and poultry plants" *Washington Post*, October 29, 2023

"Baby's first market failure" *NPR's Planet Money*, February 3, 2023

"California's child care crisis: How three families are fighting to stay afloat" *L.A. Times*, January 19, 2023

"Omicron is the latest disaster for working parents" *CNN Business*, January 14, 2022

"Child Care in Crisis: Can Biden's Plan Save It?" *New York Times*, March 31, 2021

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

2027: American Economic Assocation *(scheduled)*, University of Virginia (Education) *(scheduled)*

2026: Association for Education Finance and Policy, University of Virginia, Dartmouth College *(scheduled)*

2025: Princeton University, Florida State University, Society of Labor Economists, Association for Public Policy & Management, Southern Economic Association

2024: American Economic Association, Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, Society of Labor Economists, Triangle Economics of Education Workshop, Brookings Institution, NBER Summer Institute, Association for Public Policy & Management, Southern Economic Association

2023: University of Notre Dame Alumni Conference, Princeton University Industrial Relations Centennial, University of Virginia (Education), Southern Economic Association

2022: Association for Public Policy & Management, Clemson University, Census LED Webinar, Carolina Regional Empirical Economics Day, Southern Economic Association

2021: Association for Education Finance and Policy, Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop

2020: Eastern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Tufts University

2019: University of South Carolina, Joint Committee on Taxation, George Washington University, Upjohn Institute, Federal Trade Commission, Association for Education Finance and Policy, Association for Public Policy & Management, Southeastern Health Economics Study Group

2018: University of Notre Dame, Princeton University, Economics Graduate Students' Conference at Washington University in St. Louis, Haverford College

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee:
AERA Open, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Journal of Public Health, B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy, Child & Youth Care Forum, Contemporary Economic Policy, The Economic Journal, Economica, Education Finance and Policy, Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis, Evaluation and Program Planning, Health Economics, International Journal of Child Care and Education Policy, Journal of Demographic Economics, Journal of Family and Economic Issues, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Human Capital, Journal of Human Resources, Journal of Labor Economics, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Urban Economics, LABOUR: Review of Labour Economics and Industrial Relations, Oxford Economic Papers, PLOS ONE, Quantitative Economics, Review of Economics of the Household, Social Service Review, Southern Economic Journal

Grant Reviewer:
Alfred P. Sloan Foundation, Inter-American Development Bank GDLab ("The Care Economy" external advisor), Washington Center for Equitable Growth

Program Committees:

2027: Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference (Early Education)
2026: Association for Public Policy & Management Annual Conference (Child & Family Policy)
2025: Association for Public Policy & Management Annual Conference (Child & Family Policy; Education)
2024: Association for Public Policy & Management Annual Conference (Child & Family Policy)

Updated: October 2026